

AN OPEN LETTER AND FORMAL DEMAND FOR ANSWERS

Regarding the CA-14 Congressional Endorsement

TO: Jeanne Solnordal, Chairwoman, Alameda County Republican Party,
1039 MacArthur Blvd, San Leandro, CA 94577
Corrin Rankin, Chairwoman, California Republican Party,
1001 K St., 4th Floor, Sacramento, CA 95814

FROM: The Republican Voters, Donors, and Supporters of California's 14th Congressional District

RE: The CA-14 Endorsement of Dena Maldonado Over Wendy Huang —
Questions That Demand Public Answers

DATE: June 16th, 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Ten Questions That Admit No Procedural Escape

The questions that follow span twenty-two sections and cover every dimension of the CA-14 endorsement decision — from the process itself to the strategic consequences, from financial compliance to personal vetting, from conflicts of interest and attorney involvement, to contingency plans for contesting election results, to the national security obligations of representing a district that contains Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory and Sandia National Laboratories. Before those sections begin, ten questions are presented here. They are the ones whose answers are either a matter of public record or a matter of basic institutional obligation. None has been publicly addressed. None has been answered. The full document that follows asks them in comprehensive and specific detail.

1. What is the exact date the endorsement was granted — and how many months had Dena Maldonado been a registered Republican voter in Alameda County on that date? California voter registration records are public. This is a verifiable fact. Why has neither chairwoman stated it?
2. Can either chairwoman name a single Republican voter, candidate, elected official, or organization — outside the county and state party apparatus — who independently endorsed or expressed support for Dena Maldonado before the endorsement was granted?

3. Has Dena Maldonado ever appeared on any ballot, in any election, in any jurisdiction, at any level, at any point in her life?
4. Can either chairwoman point to any public document, verified filing, or official record that establishes Dena Maldonado's highest level of educational attainment?
5. Chairwoman Solnordal: the Alameda County Republican Party's own published endorsement list for the endorsement list published in March 2026 shows 'Congressional District 14: Dena Maldonado' and 'Assembly District 14: Borgar Solnordal.' Is Borgar Solnordal a family member? If yes — did you recuse yourself from either endorsement, and were Republican voters informed of that relationship before the endorsements were announced?
6. Was Wendy Huang — a duly elected Alameda County Republican Central Committeewoman — ever personally notified by either chairwoman that she would not receive the endorsement, given any written explanation for that decision, or offered any opportunity to respond before the announcement was made public?
7. Eric Swalwell has resigned in disgrace following sexual misconduct allegations and a House Ethics investigation. CA-14 was an open seat. Wendy Huang achieved a stronger showing and got more votes than Dena Maldonado without any GOP county and state party support. Now that these facts are on the public record — will either chairwoman acknowledge that the endorsement decision was a mistake?
8. Did the endorsement by you or a committee ever conduct a direct, documented, side-by-side comparison of Wendy Huang and Dena Maldonado on winnability in CA-14? If yes — will either chairwoman release that analysis? If no — on what basis was the endorsement made?
9. If the Department of Justice, the FBI, or any federal or state investigative agency opens a criminal or civil investigation into conduct related to the CA-14 endorsement process, will both chairwomen commit in writing — today — that no party funds will be used to pay for their personal legal defense?
10. This document has been submitted to both chairwomen on the public record. Will either of you defend the endorsement decision publicly, in writing, with specific answers to the questions herein, within 30 days of receipt? A non-response will be presented to Republican voters, news media, and relevant oversight bodies as a non-answer.

Chairwoman Solnordal. Chairwoman Rankin.

The Republican voters of California's 14th Congressional District deserve direct answers — not talking points, not deflection, and not silence.

What follows is a comprehensive accounting of the questions your endorsement decision has raised and left unanswered. These questions are specific. They are reasonable. They concern the use of institutional party power that belongs to Republican voters — not to party officers. They are framed as requests for transparency and accountability, not as allegations. And they remain, as of this date, entirely unanswered.

The fastest path to ending this scrutiny is the simplest one: answer the questions, release the records, and let the facts speak for themselves. If the process was fair, transparency will prove it. If it was not, the voters of CA-14 — and every Republican voter in California — deserve to know.

SECTION 1: ON THE ENDORSEMENT PROCESS ITSELF

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, the voters of CA-14 ask you directly:

- Who first proposed endorsing Dena Maldonado?
- Who ultimately approved that decision — and in what capacity?
- Were written endorsement criteria established and documented before candidates were formally under consideration?
- If criteria were established after the process was already underway, who wrote them, and when?
- Was the endorsement timeline publicly announced in advance?
- Were all Republican candidates in CA-14 notified of the process on equal terms and given an equal opportunity to present their credentials?
- Were candidate interviews conducted?
- If interviews were conducted, where are the records, notes, scorecards, and recommendations produced from those sessions?
- How many votes were cast by endorsement committee members?
- What were the final vote totals?
- Was a quorum of the endorsement committee present when the vote was taken?
- Are signed attendance records from that meeting available — and will they be released?
- Were endorsement committee members provided materials from all candidates in equal form, or were some candidates' information presented more completely or favorably than others?
- Did the party conduct any objective vetting — background research, fundraising analysis, or voter contact capacity assessment — before the endorsement was granted?
- Did any member of the endorsement committee raise concerns about Maldonado's campaign infrastructure, fundraising capacity, voter outreach, or organizational readiness?
- Was Wendy Huang personally notified by either chairwoman that she would not receive the endorsement — before the announcement was made public?
- Was any written rationale provided to candidates who were not endorsed, explaining the basis for the committee's decision?
- What is the exact date the endorsement was announced? How many days had Dena Maldonado been a registered Republican voter in Alameda County on that date?
- Was the endorsement process conducted in compliance with the California Republican Party's own bylaws and standing rules — and can either of you confirm this in writing?

SECTION 2: ON THE LOGIC OF THE ENDORSEMENT CHOICE

Chairwoman Solnordal, as the Alameda County Republican Party Chairwoman, and Chairwoman Rankin, as head of the state party that co-endorsed this decision, you are asked:

- What specific qualifications led the committee to select a candidate who had relocated to Alameda County from San Diego County shortly before the endorsement, over a candidate with years of documented community roots, civic engagement, prior candidacies, and active Republican Party service in the district?
- How long had Dena Maldonado been a resident of CA-14 at the time the endorsement was made?
- Public records show she was registered as a Republican in San Diego County from 2016 to 2025 and in Alameda County from 2025 to 2026. Was the committee aware of this registration history?
- Had she voted in any Alameda County election prior to receiving the party's endorsement?
- What weight, if any, did the process assign to length of residency, depth of community ties, and prior voter engagement in the district?
- How did the committee evaluate Wendy Huang's qualifications — her status as a duly elected Alameda County Republican Central Committeewoman, her record as a Republican voter and donor in the district, her multiple prior local candidacies in politics, her established family roots in the community, and her endorsements from multiple Republican organizations, candidates, and elected officials?
- Why were those qualifications found insufficient?
- Can either of you identify a single Republican voter, candidate, elected official, or organization — outside the county and state party GOP apparatus — who independently endorsed or expressed support for Dena Maldonado before the endorsement was granted?
- If the answer is no, what does the complete absence of independent grassroots Republican support say about the evidentiary basis for the endorsement?
- Wendy Huang was democratically elected as Alameda County Republican Central Committeewoman by Republican voters in the district. What would either of you say to those voters — whose democratic choice was effectively overridden by an unelected endorsement committee — to explain why their mandate was not honored?
- Was any concern raised within the committee that endorsing a recent arrival from San Diego County to Alameda County over a locally elected Republican leader might signal to voters that the process was driven by internal relationships rather than voter preference?
- If a candidate can receive a party endorsement within months of relocating from another region of California, with no independent organizational support and no prior engagement with local Republican voters, what does that reveal about what this endorsement process was actually measuring?
- If it was not measuring electability, community credibility, or grassroots support — what, exactly, was it measuring?

SECTION 3: ON ELECTORAL EXPERIENCE AND DEMOCRATIC LEGITIMACY

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, the voters ask you:

- Did the endorsement committee require candidates to describe their prior electoral history as part of the application process?
- Did the committee have a minimum electoral experience requirement for endorsement?
- If no minimum experience requirement existed, should it have — and will either of you commit to establishing one?
- Has Dena Maldonado ever appeared on any ballot in any election — local, state, or federal — in California or any other state?
- Has Dena Maldonado ever been elected to any public office, appointed board, party position, or representative body by any group of voters anywhere?
- Had Dena Maldonado ever been a candidate in any Republican primary — at any level — prior to this congressional race?
- Has she ever sought election to any local office — school board, city council, water board, fire district, hospital district, or community college board?
- Did Dena Maldonado hold any elected position in the San Diego County Republican Party — or any party organization anywhere — before she relocated to Alameda County?
- Has Dena Maldonado ever served as an elected precinct captain, party delegate, or Central Committee member in San Diego County or in the City of La Mesa?
- If the answers above are uniformly no — has either of you considered what it means to ask CA-14 Republican voters to make her their congressional nominee when no voters, anywhere, at any level, have ever previously chosen to place their electoral trust in her?
- Wendy Huang has run in multiple local elections and been elected by Republican voters as Alameda County Republican Central Committeewoman. Did you or the committee weigh that demonstrated electoral track record as a meaningful differentiator?
- Did you or any committee member raise the concern that endorsing a candidate who had never appeared on a ballot was not a responsible use of the party's institutional endorsement power?
- If a candidate cannot point to a single election — at any level, in any jurisdiction, at any point in her life — in which any voters chose her, on what grounds did either of you conclude that the Republican voters of CA-14 should be the very first?

SECTION 4: ON DEMOGRAPHIC STRATEGY AND VOTER OUTREACH CAPACITY

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, CA-14 have one of the most significant Chinese-American voter populations in California and in the country. You are asked:

- Did the endorsement committee conduct any demographic analysis of the district's voter composition before making its decision?
- Was the significant presence of Chinese-speaking voters in CA-14 identified as a relevant factor in evaluating candidate viability?
- Wendy Huang speaks Chinese and has direct cultural, linguistic, and community ties to the Chinese-American voter base in Alameda County. Did the committee consider her ability to communicate directly with Chinese-speaking voters — in their own language, without an interpreter, and with cultural authenticity — as a meaningful electoral advantage?
- Did the committee ask each candidate what languages they speak fluently?
- Did the committee ask whether each candidate was capable of conducting voter outreach, holding community forums, and communicating directly in Chinese?
- Was any consideration given to how a candidate without Chinese language ability or cultural connection would conduct voter registration drives, canvassing, community meetings, or get-out-the-vote efforts among a demographic that represents a substantial share of the Republican electorate in CA-14?
- Did the committee consult with Chinese-American Republican community leaders, Chinese-language media outlets, or Chinese-American civic organizations in Alameda County before making its endorsement?
- In a district where Chinese is a widespread community language representing a substantial and organized voter demographic, what is the strategic logic of endorsing a candidate with no demonstrable connection to that community over a Chinese-American candidate who is herself a member of it?
- How does the party expect to grow its coalition among Chinese-American voters — a growing and politically persuadable demographic — by endorsing a non-Chinese candidate over a highly qualified Chinese-American candidate?
- Will either of you publicly explain to the Asian and our Chinese-American Republican community in Alameda County why a candidate without linguistic access, cultural connection, or prior presence in their community was judged to be a stronger representative of their interests than one who has lived among them and spoken for them for decades?

SECTION 5: ON HOME OWNERSHIP, HOUSING STABILITY, AND COST OF LIVING CREDIBILITY

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, the cost of living is the single most cited concern among voters in CA-14 and across Alameda County. You are asked:

- Did the endorsement committee ask each candidate whether they own a home in CA-14 or Alameda County?
- Does Dena Maldonado own a home in the congressional-district she is seeking to represent?
- If she is renting, when did she establish that rental residence?
- Has she made any long-term financial commitment to remaining in the district beyond this election cycle?
- Did the committee ask candidates whether they had purchased a home, paid a California mortgage, and lived under the full weight of this state's housing costs?
- A congressional representative who does not own property in their district — and who relocated there only months before seeking its highest federal office — may struggle to credibly advocate for homeowners dealing with mortgage rates, insurance premiums, and property taxes. Did the committee consider this credibility gap?
- Did the committee ask candidates to describe their personal experience with California's cost of living and how it informs their policy positions?
- Will either of you publicly disclose whether the endorsed candidate owns or rents her current residence in CA-14, and how long she has resided at that location?
- If the endorsed candidate does not own a home in the district and has resided there only months, how do you believe she can authentically represent the homeowners and established families whose cost-of-living concerns are driving the vote in CA-14?

SECTION 6: ON TECHNOLOGY BACKGROUND AND CAPACITY TO REPRESENT A TECH DISTRICT

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, CA-14 is home to Tesla's Fremont manufacturing plant, Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory, the Tri-Valley innovation corridor, and is close to UC Berkeley and national research institutions. Its economy, workforce, and national security significance are defined by technology and advanced manufacturing. You are asked:

- Did your endorsement consider each candidate's technology background, work-experience, and policy fluency as relevant criteria for representing this district?
- What specific technology experience does Dena Maldonado bring to CA-14?
- Public election records identify her as a florist and swimsuit fashion designer. What technology qualifications — if any — were presented to the committee on her behalf?
- Was the endorsed candidate asked to describe her position on artificial intelligence regulation, legislation, and workforce displacement?
- Was she asked about semiconductor supply chain security?
- Was she asked about data privacy, cybersecurity, or broadband infrastructure?
- Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory conducts research critical to national security and nuclear deterrence. Did you ask each candidate whether they have any familiarity with the laboratory's mission, its funding mechanisms, and the policy decisions that govern its operation?
- The competition between the United States and China in artificial intelligence, semiconductor manufacturing, and quantum computing is a defining national security challenge and concern. Did you ask each candidate to describe their understanding of that competition and the federal policies they would champion to advance American technological leadership?
- Wendy Huang is a retired technology executive who served as Director of Sales and Marketing and Director of Operations at a technology firm. Did the committee weigh that professional background as a meaningful advantage in a district where technology is the defining economic identity of the community?
- Technology sector voters, donors, and civic leaders in CA-14 are among the most analytically rigorous constituencies in the country. On what basis did either of you conclude that a candidate with no documented technology background is better positioned to earn their confidence than a candidate who built her career in that industry?
- Will either of you publicly identify what technology background, policy knowledge, or industry experience qualifies Dena Maldonado to represent a district in which technology is the foundational identity of the economy and the national interest?

SECTION 7: ON POLICY POSITIONS AND ISSUE VETTING

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, you are asked:

- Did you ask each candidate to state their position on the issues Republican primary voters in CA-14 consider most defining — or was the endorsement granted without any structured policy evaluation?
- Was each candidate asked directly and on the record whether they are pro-life?
- Were their answers compared against any prior public statements, interviews, social media posts, or recorded positions to verify consistency?
- Were candidates asked to articulate their specific position on abortion policy — including their views on exceptions, gestational limits, and the scope of any legislation they would support or oppose?
- Were candidates asked about United States policy toward Israel, including military aid, diplomatic recognition, and America's strategic alliance obligations?
- Were candidates asked about the conflict in Gaza — including their position on humanitarian aid, civilian casualties, ceasefire negotiations, and how they would vote on related appropriations and resolutions?
- Were candidates asked about United States policy toward Iran — including sanctions, the nuclear program, and the threat Iran poses to Israel and American interests in the region?
- Were candidates asked about the Jeffrey Epstein case — specifically whether they support full declassification of federal investigative files and whether they would support legislation compelling transparency in the handling of the case?
- Wendy Huang has introduced and championed her own policy called the Epstein Accountability and Survivor Justice Act — original federal legislation addressing government transparency, survivor rights, and accountability for those who have evaded justice. Did you ask each candidate their position on Epstein accountability legislation?
- Were you aware that one of the candidates had made federal accountability for sexual exploitation the centerpiece of her entire congressional platform — and that CA-14 was simultaneously represented by a congressman who would resign under a House Ethics investigation for sexual misconduct against a subordinate? Did anyone in either party organization recognize the alignment between Wendy Huang's legislation and the political moment CA-14 voters were about to experience?
- Were candidates' stated positions cross-checked against their prior public record — interviews, social media activity, campaign statements, donations, organizational memberships — to identify any inconsistencies?
- Were candidates who had no prior public record on any of these issues asked how voters could assess the authenticity of positions stated for the first time in a closed endorsement interview?
- Did the committee document each candidate's responses to policy questions — and will those records be released?
- Wendy Huang has been on public record in advocating for a reinvestigation of the Jeffrey Epstein case, did this affect your decision not to endorse her?

SECTION 8: ON FOREIGN NATIONAL INVOLVEMENT AND FARA COMPLIANCE

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, federal law prohibits foreign nationals from participating in American elections. You are asked:

- Did you ask each candidate whether they have received, are receiving, or anticipate receiving any direct or indirect support — financial, organizational, or logistical — from any foreign national, foreign government, foreign political party, or foreign-controlled entity?
- Did you ask each candidate to certify in writing that no foreign national support of any kind has been solicited, accepted, or received in connection with their campaign?
- Were candidates asked to disclose any business relationships, consulting arrangements, advisory roles, speaking engagements, or financial transactions with foreign nationals or foreign-controlled organizations — past or present — that could constitute acting as a foreign agent under the Foreign Agent Registration Act?
- Were candidates asked whether any of their campaign donors, bundlers, fundraising hosts, or affiliated organizations have any financial relationship with foreign nationals or entities controlled by foreign governments?
- Were candidates asked whether they have ever been employed by, contracted with, or acted on behalf of any foreign government, foreign political party, or foreign corporation in any capacity that requires FARA registration?
- Were candidates asked whether they have ever been approached by a representative of a foreign government or foreign intelligence service seeking to influence their campaign strategy or policy positions?
- Were candidates asked whether any intermediary, fundraiser, or liaison acting on their behalf has any relationship with a foreign government — including the use of a U.S. citizen as a conduit for foreign contributions?
- If it emerged that a candidate had undisclosed ties to foreign nationals triggering FARA registration requirements, does either party have a written policy governing how it would respond?
- Will either of you commit to requiring all endorsed candidates in federal races to provide a sworn written certification that no direct or indirect foreign national support has been or will be received — and to making that certification publicly available?
- Will either of you independently verify — not solely through candidate self-reporting — that the endorsed candidate has no foreign entanglements that could expose the party or the voters of CA-14 to federal legal liability?

SECTION 9: ON CONFLICTS OF INTEREST AND FINANCIAL RELATIONSHIPS

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, the following questions concern potential conflicts of interest in the endorsement process:

- Were any consultants, political strategists, vendors, or advisors involved simultaneously with both party organizations and the endorsed campaign?
- Did any individual participate in endorsement discussions while having a financial, professional, or political relationship with the candidate or her campaign?
- Were formal recusals requested or required when potential conflicts of interest were identified?
- Were those recusal requests honored — and is there a written record?
- Did any party official, committee member, or staff member subsequently receive employment, consulting contracts, or other compensation from the endorsed campaign or its affiliated organizations?
- Did major donors to the party organization have pre-existing financial relationships with the endorsed candidate or her campaign prior to the endorsement?
- Chairwoman Solnordal: the Alameda County Republican Party's own published endorsement list for the endorsement list published in March 2026 shows 'Congressional District 14: Dena Maldonado' and 'Assembly District 14: Borgar Solnordal.' Is Borgar Solnordal a family member?
- If Borgar Solnordal is a family member: did you recuse yourself from the CA-14 endorsement deliberations, from the AD-14 endorsement deliberations, or from both — and were Republican voters and committee members informed of that family relationship before either endorsement was announced?
- If you did not recuse yourself from either endorsement despite a family connection to one of the endorsed candidates: on what basis did you participate, and who approved that participation?
- Were endorsement committee members required to sign conflict-of-interest disclosures before participating — and will those disclosures be released?
- Did any vendor, consultant, or political advisor profit from both the party endorsement process and the endorsed campaign — and if so, were those dual relationships disclosed to committee members before the vote?

SECTION 10: ON CANDIDATE VETTING AND ACADEMIC CREDENTIALS

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, Alameda County are among the most highly educated counties in California. Its voter base includes a disproportionately high concentration of residents holding advanced degrees, professional licenses, and technical credentials. You are asked:

- Did the endorsement committee request educational credentials from all candidates under consideration?
- Were candidates asked to provide documentation of academic degrees, diplomas, or certifications?
- Were those documents independently verified — or was the committee relying entirely on candidate self-reporting?
- Has Dena Maldonado publicly disclosed her educational background, including her highest level of academic achievement, in any candidate filing, campaign material, biography, endorsement application, or public forum?
- Has either party independently confirmed what educational credentials the endorsed candidate possesses?
- Can either of you point to any public document, verified filing, or official record that establishes Dena Maldonado's educational attainment?
- If a candidate's educational background was never requested, never voluntarily disclosed, and never independently verified, on what basis did the committee conclude that candidate was prepared to represent one of California's most professionally and academically credentialed congressional districts?
- Wendy Huang holds a verified degree from the University of California, Davis. Was the same credential verification standard applied equally to all candidates?
- Will either of you now ask the endorsed candidate to publicly release documentation of her educational credentials so that voters can make an informed judgment?
- If the endorsed candidate cannot or will not document her educational background, will either party revisit its endorsement?

SECTION 11: ON PERSONAL BACKGROUND AND CHARACTER VETTING

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, you are asked whether any of the following personal background questions were asked of the endorsed candidate to ensure electability:

- Did the endorsement committee conduct any personal background vetting of candidates before granting the endorsement?
- Was Dena Maldonado asked whether she is married?
- Was she asked whether she has children?
- Was she asked whether she regularly attends a church or religious congregation?
- Given that she relocated to Alameda County only months before the endorsement, did the committee ask which specific church or faith community she had joined or attended since arriving in the district?
- Was she able to name any pastor, faith leader, or religious community member in Alameda County who could speak to her character and her integration into a local faith community?
- Was she asked to identify any Alameda County neighbors, local business owners, community organizers, or civic leaders who knew her personally and could vouch for her character?
- Were candidates asked about their social media history or prior public statements that might conflict with the values and platform of the California Republican Party?
- Was Maldonado's personal financial background reviewed — including whether she has the financial stability voters in a competitive district would expect of their congressional representative?
- Were any of the personal background questions verified independently — or was the committee relying entirely on candidate self-reporting?
- Wendy Huang is a married mother, a homeowner, a member of a Taiwanese Christian church with a documented record of community service, and a professional with a verified academic and career background. Was this personal background context weighed alongside the corresponding background of the endorsed candidate?
- If none of these personal background questions were asked or verified, what precisely did the endorsement committee believe it was endorsing — and on what basis?

SECTION 12: ON INTERNAL DISSENT AND STRATEGIC WARNINGS

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, you are asked:

- Did any party official, Central Committee delegate, or precinct captain formally object to the endorsement in writing?
- If formal objections were submitted, how were they addressed — and by whom?
- Were rank-and-file party members, precinct captains, or Central Committee delegates consulted before the endorsement was finalized — or was the decision made without grassroots input?
- Were established Republican women's organizations in Alameda County — which might be expected to have particular interest in the endorsement of a congressional candidate who is a Chinese-American woman — consulted before the endorsement was granted?
- Did the party receive warnings from donors, volunteers, or field operatives that the endorsement lacked support among the Republican base in CA-14?
- Were internal polls, voter surveys, or data analyses conducted showing voter preferences among Republican candidates in CA-14 before the endorsement was made?
- If such data existed, what did it show — and did it factor into the endorsement decision?
- Were either of you warned that endorsing a candidate with limited campaign infrastructure could split the Republican vote in CA-14 and prevent a stronger Republican from advancing?
- Did anyone inside the state or county party discuss the possibility that the endorsement would benefit Democratic candidates by dividing Republican support?
- Did any party official recommend delaying or withholding an endorsement until candidates could be more thoroughly evaluated — and if so, was that recommendation rejected, and by whom?

SECTION 13: ON COMMUNICATIONS BETWEEN PARTY ORGANIZATIONS

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, you are asked:

- What communications occurred between California Republican Party officials and Alameda County Republican Party officials regarding CA-14 before the endorsement decision was made?
- Were any communications made to or from the National Republican Congressional Committee (NRCC) regarding the CA-14 race or endorsement before, during, or after the decision?
- Did national party officials or their staff express any formal or informal preference among Republican candidates in CA-14?
- Were any California Republican officeholders, their chiefs of staff, or their campaign staff involved in communications regarding the endorsement decision?
- Did any party official communicate with outside political organizations, super PACs, or allied groups regarding which candidate to support in CA-14?
- Are records of all these communications preserved?
- Will either of you commit to releasing those records?

SECTION 14: ON CAMPAIGN COMPLIANCE AND FINANCIAL REPORTING

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, you are asked:

- Were all campaign signs, mailers, digital advertisements, and voter communications by the endorsed campaign compliant with California's disclosure requirements, including required 'paid for by' statements?
- If any campaign materials lacked required disclosures, who authorized those materials?
- Who paid for them?
- Were any expenditures made on behalf of the campaign that were not properly reported to the California Secretary of State or the Federal Election Commission?
- Were any party resources — staff time, email lists, voter databases, or digital infrastructure — used to benefit the endorsed campaign in ways not reported as in-kind contributions?
- Did any independent expenditure committees, political action committees, or third-party organizations communicate with campaign representatives regarding strategy, messaging, voter targeting, or outreach?
- Were any such communications properly reported as required by law?
- Were any payments made to vendors or consultants in connection with CA-14 endorsement activity that were not reflected in required party financial filings?
- Did the endorsed campaign file all required state and federal campaign finance reports accurately and on time?

SECTION 15: ON INFORMATION FAIRNESS AND VOTER COMMUNICATION

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, you are asked:

- Were voter guides, endorsement materials, party websites, and official communications presented in a way that fairly and completely informed voters about all Republican candidates in the race?
- Did official party communications direct voters to the endorsed candidate's website, social media accounts, or fundraising pages while omitting equivalent information for other Republican candidates?
- Were non-endorsed Republican candidates ever given an opportunity to present their credentials in official party communications or at party-sponsored events?
- Were party email lists, social media accounts, or digital platforms used to promote the endorsed candidate in ways not equally available to all Republican candidates in the race?
- Did party representatives make public statements at candidate forums, town halls, or community events that signaled support for one candidate while discouraging voters from considering others?
- Did party-distributed voter guides present all candidates' positions and qualifications with equal accuracy and completeness — or were descriptions selectively framed?
- Why were some candidates prominently featured in party communications while others received limited or no visibility?

SECTION 16: ON THE OPEN SEAT AND THE OPPORTUNITY THE ENDORSEMENT COST REPUBLICANS

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, Eric Swalwell announced his resignation from Congress in April of 2026, following multiple allegations of sexual assault and sexual misconduct and after the House Ethics Committee announced a formal investigation into his conduct. His resignation took effect April 14, 2026. CA-14 is now an open seat. The special primary election is being held June 16, 2026 — this week — with Republicans Wendy Huang, Dena Maldonado, Tom Wong, and Jack Wu all on the ballot, splitting the Republican vote in a field that also includes six Democratic candidates. You are asked:

- The resignation of a disgraced incumbent under a House Ethics investigation for sexual misconduct is the most significant Republican pickup opportunity CA-14 has presented in over a decade. Did your endorsement decision give Republicans their strongest possible candidate for the moment when that opportunity materialized?
- If the answer is no — who is responsible for that failure?
- Swalwell carried two distinct and documented scandals: his publicly reported association with Christine Fang, a suspected Chinese intelligence operative, and the sexual misconduct allegations that ultimately forced his resignation. A Chinese-American woman running on a platform of federal accountability and government transparency would have been uniquely positioned to draw both contrasts before CA-14 voters. Did your endorsement advance or undermine that strategic opportunity?
- The special election now features four Republicans dividing the Republican vote against six Democratic candidates. Did your earlier endorsement of Maldonado over Huang contribute to the fragmented Republican field that now exists?
- Do either of you accept any responsibility for that outcome?
- Wendy Huang achieved the most votes as a Republican candidate, without any party support. Did the party's endorsement of another candidate and its influence over Republican donor and voter decisions cost Wendy Huang votes that could have secured her a stronger position entering the June 2nd Primary and June 16th special election?
- Given that outcome, what did the party's institutional endorsement ultimately accomplish for Republican voters in CA-14?
- Can either of you name a single thing Dena Maldonado brings to this race that Wendy Huang does not? If you cannot — will you explain publicly why Republican voters should have confidence that the endorsement decision was made with their interests in mind?
- Swalwell also had a publicly reported association with Christine Fang, a suspected Chinese spy alleged to have cultivated relationships with Bay Area political figures. A Taiwanese-American candidate, fluent in Chinese, running on federal accountability legislation, would have been uniquely credible in drawing that contrast. Will either of you explain why you chose not to put that candidate in the strongest possible position?
- Now that Eric Swalwell has resigned in disgrace, Dena Maldonado came in 5th place in the June 2nd Primary, and Wendy Huang won the most votes as a Republican candidate without any party support — will either chairwoman publicly and on the record acknowledge that the endorsement decision was a mistake?

SECTION 17: ON WHETHER THE COMMITTEE EVER COMPARED THE TWO CANDIDATES FOR WINNABILITY

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, this is among the most fundamental questions in this document:

- Did the endorsement by you or a committee ever conduct a direct, documented, side-by-side comparison of Wendy Huang and Dena Maldonado specifically on the question of which candidate had the stronger realistic path to winning CA-14?
- If yes — will either of you release that analysis?
- If no — on what basis did you or a committee conclude that one candidate was a stronger choice for electability than the other? How can an endorsement decision affecting the entire Republican electorate of CA-14 be justified without one?
- Consider the objective record. On one side: a retired technology executive, a duly elected Alameda County Republican Central Committeewoman, a multi-cycle candidate with prior local campaign experience, a homeowner with established family roots in the district, a fluent Chinese speaker with direct cultural access to one of the district's largest voter demographics, the author of original federal accountability legislation, a verified UC Davis graduate, a married churchgoing mother, and a candidate who achieved a strong showing without any party support. On the other side: a self-described florist and swimsuit fashion designer who relocated from San Diego County in the fall of 2025, has far as we know, never appeared on any ballot anywhere, holds no publicly verified credentials, has no documented independent endorsements from any Republican voter or organization outside the county and state party apparatus. Did the committee compare these records — and if it did, how did it reach the conclusion it reached?
- Was each candidate evaluated on the same set of winnability criteria — length of residency, depth of community ties, prior electoral experience, independent fundraising capacity, name recognition among Republican voters, breadth of endorsements, demographic alignment with key voter populations, professional background, and documented policy positions?
- If those criteria were applied consistently to both candidates, which candidate scored higher on each one — and are either of you prepared to share those scores publicly?
- Was any independent polling conducted showing each candidate's name recognition, favorability, and competitive profile against likely Democratic opponents?
- Did anyone on the committee argue that Wendy Huang represented the stronger general election candidate — and if so, how was that argument addressed, and why did it not prevail?
- Has anyone within either party organization compared the two candidates' actual primary performance against what the endorsement decision predicted — and if that comparison has been made, what did it reveal?
- If the endorsement process by you or a committee never conducted a direct, documented winnability comparison between Wendy Huang and Dena Maldonado, will either of you explain to Republican voters in CA-14 what exactly the committee or you believed it was doing — and whose interests it believed it was serving?

SECTION 18: ON LEGAL ACCOUNTABILITY AND THE USE OF PARTY RESOURCES

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, given the volume and seriousness of the questions raised in this document, you are asked:

- If the Department of Justice, the FBI, the Federal Election Commission, or any other state or federal investigative agency opens a criminal or civil investigation into conduct related to the CA-14 endorsement process, will either of you commit in writing to not using party financial resources to fund your personal legal defense?
- Will each of you personally pledge that any legal costs arising from your own conduct in the endorsement process will be paid from your own personal funds — not from party dues, member contributions, donor accounts, or committee treasuries?
- What existing party bylaws, standing rules, or written policies govern whether party financial resources may be used to pay for the legal representation of individual officers, committee members, staff, or volunteers?
- If no such policies currently exist, will either of you commit to adopting them before the next election cycle — and publishing them for all party members to review?
- Have any party funds already been directed — directly or indirectly — toward legal consultation, legal review, or legal representation in connection with CA-14 endorsement activity?
- If so, how much was spent, to which attorneys or firms, and who authorized those expenditures?
- If either of you is served with a subpoena by a grand jury, federal agency, or state investigative body, will you commit to cooperating fully and voluntarily — without contesting that subpoena using party-funded legal resources?
- Will either of you proactively and publicly disclose to rank-and-file members and donors if any portion of party funds is directed toward legal matters related to the CA-14 process — and will that disclosure occur before funds are spent, not after the fact?
- Will either of you support an independent financial audit of all party accounts to confirm that no party funds have been, or will be, used for the personal legal representation of any individual in connection with CA-14 endorsement activity?
- Should criminal charges be filed against any party official in connection with the endorsement process, will the party immediately suspend that individual from all party roles and financial decision-making authority pending the outcome of legal proceedings?

SECTION 19: ON POST-ELECTION ACCOUNTABILITY

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, you are asked:

- Has either party conducted any internal review of the CA-14 endorsement process following the election results?
- Have any endorsement committee members spoken publicly about the process — and if they have not, have either of you asked them to do so?
- Has either party formally identified what, if anything, in the CA-14 endorsement process contributed to the current electoral outcome?
- Has either party taken any disciplinary action, issued formal findings, or proposed concrete reforms as a result of what occurred in CA-14?
- If the endorsement criteria, process, and outcome were all sound — what specifically prevents either chairwoman from defending them publicly and in specific detail right now?
- Will either of you commit to publishing specific, written reforms to the endorsement process — including new quorum requirements, conflict-of-interest rules, residency and experience criteria, and transparency standards — before the next congressional election cycle?
- If yes, will either of you commit to a specific public deadline for publishing those reforms?
- Will either of you agree to an independent review of the CA-14 endorsement process and its compliance with party bylaws and California election law?
- Will either of you release emails, meeting minutes, vote tallies, financial records, and all related communications concerning the CA-14 endorsement?
- Will either of you commit to meeting personally with Wendy Huang to explain, on the record, the specific basis for the endorsement decision?
- Chairwoman Rankin, you have publicly stated that the California Republican Party's focus is on freedom, opportunity, and accountability. The voters of CA-14 ask you directly: does accountability apply only to Democrats — or does it apply equally to decisions made inside your own party's endorsement process?
- Chairwoman Solnordal, as the Chair of the Alameda County Republican Party and the most directly responsible party official for the county-level endorsement, will you personally address each of the questions in this document on the public record?

SECTION 20: ON CONTINGENCY PLANS AND THE POTENTIAL CONTESTING OF ELECTION RESULTS

The Alameda County Registrar of Voters is the official responsible for certifying the results of every election in CA-14. Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, you are asked:

- Did either the Alameda County Republican Party or the California Republican Party develop any contingency plan — formal or informal — to contest, challenge, or dispute the Alameda County Registrar of Voters' certified election results in the event that Dena Maldonado did not advance to the November General Election?
- Were any legal mechanisms, election protests, recount requests, or court challenges identified, prepared, or put on standby in connection with the CA-14 race?
- Were any attorneys, election law firms, or legal consultants retained or placed on notice to be available to challenge CA-14 election results if the endorsed candidate did not perform as expected?
- Did either party communicate with election integrity organizations, conservative legal foundations, or political action committees about the possibility of contesting CA-14 results?
- Were election observers deployed at Alameda County vote-counting facilities specifically in connection with CA-14 results — and if so, at whose direction and at whose expense?
- Did either chairwoman or any party official communicate with the Alameda County Registrar of Voters regarding the counting, tabulation, or certification process for CA-14 ballots — and if so, what was the nature of those communications?
- Were any challenges, protests, or formal objections to CA-14 ballot counting or results actually filed with the Registrar of Voters, with the California Secretary of State, or with any court — and if so, by whom, on what grounds, and at whose expense?
- Was the possibility of contesting election results discussed internally within either party organization before the election was held — and if so, under what circumstances and at what threshold?
- If a contingency plan to challenge election results existed or was discussed, did it extend to results that showed other Republican candidates outperforming the endorsed candidate — or was it exclusively designed to challenge results that adversely affected Maldonado?
- Would party funds have been used to finance any election challenge or legal contest of CA-14 results — and if so, was that use of party funds authorized by the full party leadership or decided unilaterally?
- Did the existence of any such contingency plan — or any internal discussion of contesting results — reflect a prior acknowledgment by party leadership that the endorsed candidate might not be the organic choice of CA-14 Republican voters?
- A party that genuinely believes in its endorsed candidate does not prepare contingency plans to contest the results if she loses. Will either chairwoman confirm on the public record whether any plan to contest CA-14 election results was ever discussed, drafted, or put in place — and release any communications related to that question?

SECTION 21: ON LEGAL COUNSEL AND ATTORNEY INVOLVEMENT IN THE ENDORSEMENT PROCESS

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, the involvement of attorneys in a political endorsement process raises distinct and serious questions about who was being protected, from what, and at whose expense. You are asked:

- Were any attorneys, law firms, or legal consultants involved in any aspect of the CA-14 endorsement process — including advising on endorsement criteria, reviewing endorsement procedures, attending committee meetings, or reviewing endorsement-related communications?
- If attorneys were involved, who retained them — the Alameda County Republican Party, the California Republican Party, or another party?
- Who paid for that legal counsel — and were those payments made from party funds, from the endorsed campaign's funds, or from any other source?
- Did any attorney involved in the endorsement process have a prior or concurrent professional relationship with Dena Maldonado, her campaign, her campaign consultants, or any individual or organization financially connected to her candidacy?
- Were any attorneys present — in person, by phone, or by written communication — when the endorsement vote was taken?
- Did legal counsel advise on how to structure the endorsement process in ways that would minimize the party's legal exposure — and if so, what specific concerns was that counsel designed to address?
- Were attorneys consulted regarding FARA compliance, federal campaign finance law, California Fair Political Practices Commission requirements, or in-kind contribution reporting in connection with the CA-14 endorsement?
- Were lawyers involved in drafting, reviewing, or approving the endorsement criteria used to evaluate candidates?
- Did any attorney advise either chairwoman or the endorsement committee on how to respond to concerns raised by non-endorsed candidates, party members, or the public regarding the endorsement decision?
- Were any attorney-client privilege claims invoked to prevent disclosure of communications related to the CA-14 endorsement process — and if so, by whom and covering what subject matter?
- Were lawyers retained after questions were publicly raised about the endorsement process — and if so, are party funds being used to pay for that representation?
- Did any attorney who advised on the endorsement subsequently represent the endorsed candidate's campaign, any independent expenditure committee supporting her, or any organization affiliated with her candidacy?
- An endorsement process that requires legal counsel to structure or defend is concerning. Will either chairwoman disclose the names of any attorneys or law firms retained in connection with the CA-14 endorsement process, the scope of their engagement, and the total fees paid — and confirm whether those fees were paid from party funds?

SECTION 22: ON NATIONAL SECURITY, CLASSIFIED RESEARCH, AND THE OBLIGATION TO REPRESENT A DISTRICT AT THE HEART OF AMERICA'S DEFENSE INFRASTRUCTURE

Chairwoman Solnordal and Chairwoman Rankin, CA-14 is not simply a technology district. To reiterate, it is a national security district. Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory and Sandia National Laboratories' California campus — both located in Livermore within or immediately adjacent to CA-14 — conduct some of the most sensitive classified research in the United States government, including nuclear weapons stockpile stewardship, advanced defense systems development, and national security computing at the highest classification levels. The congressional representative for CA-14 is not merely a local voice. She is a member of Congress with direct oversight responsibilities over institutions that sit at the core of American nuclear deterrence and defense infrastructure. You are asked:

- Did the endorsement committee give any weight to the national security dimensions of CA-14 when evaluating which candidate was best positioned to serve as the district's congressional representative?
- Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory is the primary institution responsible for maintaining the safety, security, and reliability of the United States nuclear weapons stockpile. Sandia National Laboratories' California campus designs and engineers the non-nuclear components of nuclear weapons systems and conducts research critical to American defense capabilities. Did the committee ask each candidate to describe their understanding of the mission, structure, and congressional funding mechanisms of these two institutions?
- The congressional representative for CA-14 may serve on committees — including the House Armed Services Committee, the Energy and Water Development Appropriations Subcommittee, and the House Science, Space, and Technology Committee — that directly govern the funding, mission, and oversight of Lawrence Livermore and Sandia. Did the committee evaluate each candidate's ability to serve effectively in that oversight role?
- Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory is home to El Capitan, currently among the world's most powerful supercomputers, used for classified national security simulations including nuclear weapons modeling and advanced defense research that cannot be replicated anywhere else in the world. Did the committee ask each candidate to describe their understanding of high-performance computing, its role in national security, and the federal policy decisions that govern its development and deployment?
- The government research and development workforce in and around Livermore — thousands of scientists, engineers, physicists, and security-cleared technical staff employed at or in support of LLNL and Sandia — constitutes one of the most highly credentialed and nationally significant workforces in any congressional district in the United States. Did the committee consider which candidate had the professional background to speak credibly to that workforce, understand their work, and advocate effectively for their programs in Congress?
- A congressional representative whose district includes two of America's most sensitive classified research facilities will receive classified briefings on national security matters, engage directly with Department of Energy and Department of Defense program managers, and make appropriations decisions affecting programs she may not be able to discuss publicly. Did the committee evaluate each candidate's capacity to engage meaningfully with classified material, technical program details, and the complex interagency relationships that govern national security research?
- Wendy Huang is a retired technology executive with a career in the technology sector and a verified technical educational background from the University of California, Davis. Did the committee consider that her professional formation — in technology, operations,

and technical business leadership — provides a foundation for understanding the work conducted at LLNL and Sandia that a candidate with no documented technical background does not possess?

- Dena Maldonado is publicly identified in California election records as a florist who relocated from San Diego County to Alameda County in the fall of 2025. Did the committee address — directly and on the record — how a candidate with no documented background in science, technology, engineering, national security policy, or defense research would be positioned to provide meaningful congressional oversight of two of the United States government's most sensitive national security installations?
- The government R&D workforce at and around Lawrence Livermore and Sandia includes personnel whose work directly advances American nuclear deterrence, cybersecurity, energy security, and defense against emerging threats including hypersonic weapons, directed energy systems, and adversarial artificial intelligence. Did the committee ask each candidate to describe their familiarity with any of these program areas — and could the endorsed candidate demonstrate any such familiarity?
- Export control law — including the International Traffic in Arms Regulations (ITAR) and the Export Administration Regulations (EAR) — governs the transfer of technology and technical knowledge related to the work conducted at LLNL and Sandia. Did the committee ask each candidate whether they have any familiarity with export control requirements, and whether they or anyone associated with their campaign has any history of activity that could raise export control concerns?
- The Christine Fang case — in which a suspected Chinese intelligence operative allegedly cultivated relationships with Bay Area elected officials, including the then-sitting congressman for CA-14 — is directly relevant to a district that contains two of the most sensitive classified national security facilities in the United States. A representative for CA-14 will be in regular contact with national laboratory directors, Department of Energy officials, and classified program managers. Did the committee conduct any evaluation of each candidate's susceptibility to foreign influence operations targeting the national security institutions within the district?
- Wendy Huang is a Chinese-American tech executive running on a platform of federal accountability and government transparency — uniquely positioned to draw direct and credible public contrasts with Swalwell's documented association with a suspected Chinese intelligence operative. Those contrasts carry particular resonance for the scientists, engineers, and security-cleared workers at LLNL and Sandia who understand better than most what foreign intelligence targeting of this district means. Did the committee recognize that specific and irreplaceable strategic asset when making its endorsement decision?
- The Department of Energy's National Nuclear Security Administration, which oversees both LLNL and Sandia's defense programs, requires congressional partners who can engage with the technical, budgetary, and policy dimensions of its mission at a level of sophistication that goes well beyond general familiarity with government operations. On what specific basis did the committee conclude that a candidate with no documented technical background, no prior electoral experience, no established relationships in the national security community, and no prior presence in the district was better positioned to be that congressional partner than a retired technology executive with established professional credibility in the technology sector?
- Will either chairwoman publicly explain, in plain terms, to the thousands of scientists, engineers, physicists, and defense researchers who live and work in CA-14 — and who

understand precisely what it means to have inadequate congressional representation for the institutions they serve — why a florist who arrived in the district months before the endorsement was granted was judged to be a more credible advocate for their work, their programs, and their national security mission than a candidate who built her career in the technology sector?

THE REAL ISSUE

This is not merely about one candidate, one endorsement, or one election.

It is about whether Republican voters in California can trust that party institutions exist to advance their choices — not to override them.

Party endorsements carry real consequences. They direct volunteers, donors, and voters. They shape media coverage and signal viability. They give one candidate institutional credibility while denying it to another. When they are granted carelessly, without transparency, or under the influence of undisclosed interests, the harm extends far beyond a single race. It erodes the confidence that makes party membership meaningful and party endorsements worth anything at all.

The seat vacated by a congressman who resigned in disgrace under investigation for sexual misconduct is now genuinely competitive. Republicans had the candidate to win it — a Chinese-American tech executive, fluent in the language of the district's most persuadable voter demographic, running on a platform of federal accountability that speaks directly to the moment CA-14 voters are living through. The question these pages ask is straightforward: why was she not the one the party chose to put forward?

The voters of CA-14 are watching. Republican voters across California are watching. And the answer — or the continued absence of one — will tell them everything they need to know about whether the party they belong to belongs to them.

Chairwoman Solnordal. Chairwoman Rankin.

Answer the questions.

Release the records.

Let the facts speak for themselves.

This document is being made available to Republican voters, donors, grassroots organizations, conservative media, and relevant federal and state oversight bodies. Both chairwomen are invited to respond publicly, in writing, with specific answers to the questions contained herein, within 30 days of receipt.

A non-response will be presented to voters as a non-answer.
